

Visualizing Koreans' Mental Representations of Low Socioeconomic Status Through Reverse Correlation

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SUMMARY

- We visualized mental representations of low-SES vs. not low-SES targets using reverse correlation (Study 1) and tested how these images shape impressions (Study 2).
- Low-SES classification images (CIs) were evaluated more negatively across most impression dimensions.
- The effects of target SES on impressions were mediated by estimated SES, indicating that facial cues shape impressions through SES inferences.

INTRO

- Socioeconomic status (SES) is a powerful cue in impression formation. Prior research has focused on verbal or contextual SES information (Brown-Iannuzzi et al., 2017).
- Less is known about how socioeconomic status is visually represented in mental images of faces.
- We visualized these mental images using reverse correlation (Study 1) and tested how they shape impressions (Study 2).

METHODS

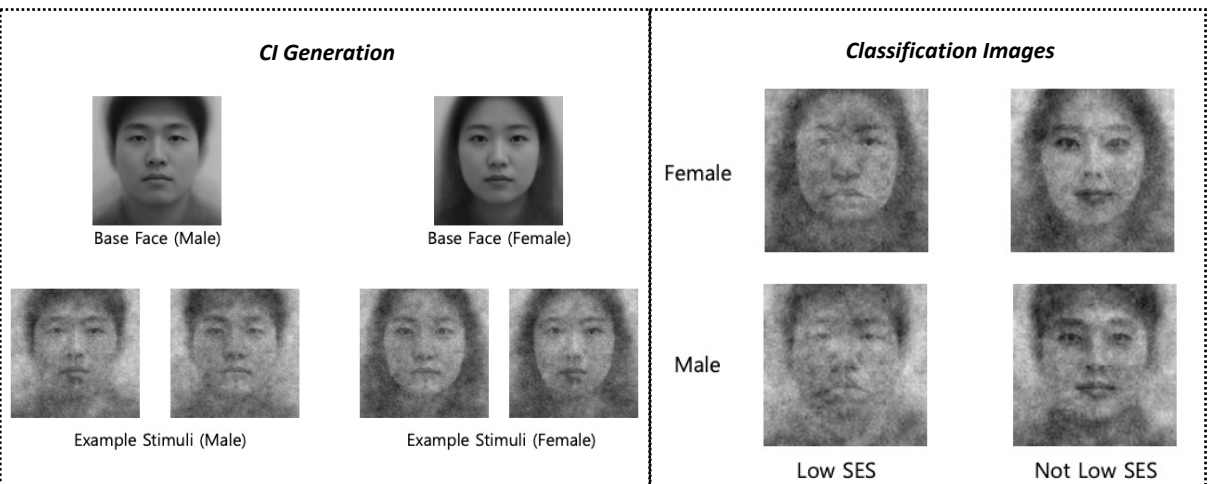
Study 1 (Visualization): 101 Korean undergraduates (31 male; $M_{age} = 21.06$, $SD_{age} = 1.87$) completed a 300-trial two-image forced choice (2IFC) task.

- Participants chose which of two faces overlaid with random noise appeared more likely to be low SES.
- Base faces were morphed composites of 100 Korean male/female faces (Moon et al., 2020).
- CIs were generated using the 'rcicr' R package (Version 1.0.1; Brinkman et al., 2017; Dotsch, 2017).

Study 2 (Evaluation): 292 Korean adults (150 females; $M_{age} = 39.32$, $SD_{age} = 11.16$) rated one of the four CIs on multiple evaluative dimensions (e.g., warmth, competence, morality).

RESULTS

- **Manipulation check:** Low-SES CIs were perceived as having lower SES than not low-SES CIs, $F(1, 288) = 168.22$, $p < .001$, $\eta^2 = .37$
- **Low-SES CIs were evaluated as:**
 - Lower in: warmth, competence, morality, agency, cleanliness, attractiveness, social distance, happiness, power, openness, conscientiousness, extraversion
 - Higher in: dangerousness, neuroticism
 - No reliable difference in: experience, toughness, agreeableness



DISCUSSION

- Korean participants associated specific facial features with low SES, and these visual cues shaped trait impressions consistent with prior SES stereotypes.
- These CIs offer a useful tool for future research on SES-based discrimination and person perception.
- Future studies should examine whether similar visual representations of SES emerge across different cultural contexts.

Indirect effects of target SES on impression outcomes via estimated SES

Outcomes	<i>B</i>	95% CI
Warmth	0.64	[0.41, 0.88]
Competence	0.82	[0.63, 1.04]
Morality	0.73	[0.52, 0.97]
Agency	0.91	[0.70, 1.14]
Experience (ns)	0.14	[0.00, 0.29]
Dangerousness	-0.57	[-0.82, -0.33]
Toughness	0.29	[0.09, 0.50]
Cleanliness	0.73	[0.52, 0.97]
Attractiveness	0.87	[0.65, 1.11]
Social distance	0.81	[0.60, 1.06]
Happiness	0.77	[0.58, 0.99]
Power	0.92	[0.68, 1.19]
Openness	0.37	[0.21, 0.54]
Conscientiousness	0.65	[0.44, 0.88]
Extraversion	0.64	[0.42, 0.87]
Agreeableness	0.44	[0.28, 0.61]
Neuroticism	-0.41	[-0.59, -0.25]

Note. *B* indicates unstandardized regression coefficients for indirect effects and respective 95% CIs.



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Title:
Subtitle

Leeroy Jenkins, author2,
author3, author4

INTRO

- Just give context for the gap you're filling

METHODS

1. N = ###,
2. Collected this
3. Tested with X statistical test

RESULTS

- Graph or table with essential results only.
- All "extra" correlations, etc. in the side bar.

DISCUSSION

- "If this result actually generalized and I didn't have to humbly disclaim the possibility of a thousand confounds and limitations, it would imply that...."

Main finding goes here,
translated into plain English.
Emphasize the important words.

You can add a focal graphic here.

Delete this and replace it with your...

- Things you want to highlight.
- Extra Graphs, Tables, Figures
- Extra nuance that you're worried about leaving out.

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